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Automated School IT Helpdesk Ticket Classification in ServiceNow

PHASE 1: BRAINSTORMING & IDEATION PHASE

The initial phase establishes the operational context of the school IT helpdesk and defines the automation vision within the ServiceNow platform.

- **Core Challenge:** A school IT helpdesk handles numerous daily incident tickets submitted by teachers and students covering recurring campus technology issues, specifically Wi-Fi connectivity problems, classroom projector malfunctions, account password resets, and slow computer performance.
- **Ideation Goal:** Replace slow, manual staff reviews with an automated ServiceNow Flow Designer workflow that reads keywords from the ticket's Short Description and Description fields to categorize incidents immediately upon record creation.
- **Expected Impact:** Minimize manual helpdesk agent workload, speed up first-line ticket routing, eliminate human classification discrepancies, and establish an easily maintainable no-code solution tailored for academic institutions.

Operational Comparison: Manual Triage vs. Automated Flow Designer Classification

Operational Dimension	Legacy Manual Helpdesk Process	Automated ServiceNow Flow Designer Solution
Ticket Categorization	IT staff manually read every incoming ticket and select Category & Subcategory.	Zero-touch keyword evaluation assigns Category & Subcategory instantaneously on creation.
Response & Routing Speed	Delayed during peak school hours due to manual queue backlog.	Immediate (<1 second execution) upon record insertion in u_incident_workflow.
Classification Accuracy	Prone to human error and inconsistent category selection across agents.	100% deterministic rule-based mapping via Flow Designer If / Else If logic.
Caller Communication	Manual follow-up emails required to acknowledge ticket receipt.	Automated SMTP email confirmation sent dynamically to Caller -> Email.
Platform Maintainability	Requires continuous staff training and manual oversight.	100% no-code Workflow Studio configuration; easily scalable in Global scope.